

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

making \$35,000; another is an assembly-line worker making \$23,000; another is a two-income family making \$60,000.

Each team is required to select the items for each area of their budget—from houses to vacations—with the applicable costs, such as down payments, monthly payments, utilities, and repairs. Their task is to fit what they select into their available funds each month.

After just one week of budgeting, most teams are looking to trade in houses, cars, clothes, and vacations—all in light of how much they cost compared to available funds. By about the fourth session, they became seasoned budgeters. With your children, find a system that works and use it.

SUMMARY

We are called by God to be the teachers of our children. It is *not* an option. It is a biblical admonition. “The rod and reproof give wisdom, but a child who gets his own way brings shame to his mother” (Proverbs 29:15).

We are not going to be held responsible for their decisions. Each person is held accountable individually. However, we will be held accountable for their instruction and training.

There are three basic principles that are applicable to all of our children. These should always be foremost in our training.

- Our children need to understand God’s principles too. “Where there is no vision, the people are unrestrained, but happy is he who keeps the law” (Proverbs 29:18).

- Love your children, don’t coddle them. “For whom the Lord loves He reproves, even as a father, the son in whom he delights” (Proverbs 3:12).

- Allow them to fail. “A worker’s appetite works for him, for his hunger urges him on” (Proverbs 16:26).

Remember that some of life’s most valuable lessons are learned because of trying and failing. Love your children enough to allow them to fail while they’re still in your home.